

INTERNAL PROCEDURE

Data Retention and Deletion Policy

Version 1.0 | Effective date: 9 July 2026

1. Purpose

This policy explains how long key data categories should be retained for the booking service and when they should be securely deleted or de-identified.

2. Guiding principle

Personal information should only be retained for as long as it is reasonably needed for booking operations, customer service, legal compliance, accounting support, security, dispute handling, backup cycles, and related business continuity purposes.

3. Core retention categories

- Guest bookings and enquiries: retain for the operational and record-keeping period adopted by the business, then delete or de-identify unless a longer retention period is required.
- User account records: retain while the account is active and for a reasonable security and audit period after deactivation.
- Password reset tokens and temporary security artefacts: delete automatically when expired, used, or no longer needed.
- Backups: retain in line with the managed database backup schedule and automatic expiry settings.
- Incident and security records: retain for as long as reasonably required to investigate, remediate, defend, or evidence a security event.

4. Deletion process

- When information is no longer needed, delete it from live systems where practicable.
- Where immediate deletion from backups is not practicable, allow data to age out under the backup retention cycle and avoid restoring it into active use unless required.
- Where possible and appropriate, de-identify data instead of retaining direct personal identifiers.

5. Holds and exceptions

If data is required for a complaint, dispute, fraud review, chargeback, legal claim, insurance matter, regulator request, or security investigation, place the relevant records on hold until the matter is resolved.

6. Review

Review retention settings and operational practices at least annually or when laws, business requirements, hosting providers, or customer expectations materially change.